UNIT I - WORKING WITH GRAMMAR

1. Sentence Construction

A sentence is a group of words that expresses a complete thought. It must have a **subject** (who or what) and a **predicate** (what is said about the subject). Basic pattern: **Subject + Verb + Object/Complement**.

- **Subject + Verb:** The baby smiled.
- **Subject + Verb + Object:** She wrote a letter.
- **Subject + Verb + Complement:** He is a teacher.
- **Subject + Verb + Indirect Object + Direct Object:** He gave me a pen.

2. Types of Sentences

By function:

Type	Purpose	Example
Declarative	States a fact or opinion	The train arrived on time.
Interrogative	Asks a question	Where do you live?
Imperative	Gives a command or request	Please close the door.
Exclamatory	Shows strong feeling	What a beautiful day!

By structure:

Type	Meaning	Example
Simple	One independent clause	I like tea.
Compound	Two independent clauses joined by and, but, or, so	I like tea, but she likes coffee.
Complex	One independent + one or more dependent clauses	I stayed home because it was raining.
Compound-complex	Two independent + at least one dependent clause	I stayed home because it rained, and she went out.

3. Parts of Speech

Part	Function	Examples
Noun	Name of a person, place, thing or idea	Ravi, Chennai, book, honesty
Pronoun	Takes the place of a noun	he, she, they, it, who
Verb	Shows action or state	run, is, think
Adjective	Describes a noun	tall boy, red car
Adverb	Describes a verb, adjective or adverb	walks slowly, very good
Preposition	Shows relation to a noun or pronoun	in, on, at, under, between
Conjunction	Joins words, phrases or clauses	and, but, because, although
Interjection	Expresses sudden feeling	Oh! Wow! Alas!

4. Auxiliary Verbs

Auxiliary (helping) verbs work with the main verb to show tense, voice, mood or question form.

- **Primary auxiliaries:** be (am, is, are, was, were), have (has, had), do (does, did). Example: She **is** singing. They **have** finished. **Do** you know him?
- **Modal auxiliaries:** can, could, may, might, shall, should, will, would, must, ought to. They show ability, permission, possibility, advice or obligation. Example: You **should** rest. **May** I come in?

5. Singular and Plural

- Add **-s**: book, books. Add **-es** after s, x, z, ch, sh: bus, buses; box, boxes.
- Consonant + y becomes **-ies**: city, cities. Vowel + y adds -s: boy, boys.
- Many words ending in f/fe change to **-ves**: leaf, leaves; knife, knives.
- **Irregular:** man, men; woman, women; child, children; foot, feet; tooth, teeth; mouse, mice; person, people.
- **Same in both:** sheep, deer, fish. **Always plural:** scissors, trousers, clothes. **Uncountable (no plural):** information, advice, furniture, luggage.

6. Active and Passive Voice

In the active voice the subject performs the action. In the passive voice the subject receives the action. Passive = **object becomes subject + be-verb + past participle (V3) + by + agent**.

Tense	Active	Passive
Simple present	She writes a letter.	A letter is written by her.
Simple past	He broke the glass.	The glass was broken by him.
Simple future	They will finish the work.	The work will be finished by them.
Present continuous	I am reading a book.	A book is being read by me.
Present perfect	We have won the match.	The match has been won by us.

7. Degrees of Comparison

Positive	Comparative	Superlative
tall	taller	tallest
happy	happier	happiest
beautiful	more beautiful	most beautiful
good / well	better	best
bad	worse	worst
far	farther / further	farthest / furthest

Use **than** with the comparative (She is taller than me) and **the** with the superlative (He is the best player). Do not use double comparatives such as 'more better'.

8. Determiners

Determiners come before a noun to show which one, how many or whose.

- **Articles:** a, an, the. Use *an* before a vowel sound (an hour, an umbrella) and *a* before a consonant sound (a university).
- **Demonstratives:** this, that, these, those.
- **Possessives:** my, your, his, her, its, our, their.

- **Quantifiers:** some, any, much, many, few, little, several, enough.
- **Numerals:** one, two, first, second. **Distributives:** each, every, either, neither.

9. Subject-Verb Agreement

- A singular subject takes a singular verb; a plural subject takes a plural verb. The **boy plays**; the **boys play**.
- Subjects joined by **and** take a plural verb: Ravi and Kumar **are** friends.
- With **either...or / neither...nor**, the verb agrees with the nearer subject: Neither the teacher nor the students **were** present.
- Words such as each, every, everyone, nobody, someone take a singular verb: Everyone **is** here.
- Collective nouns (team, committee, family) take a singular verb when seen as one unit: The team **has** won.
- Ignore words between the subject and verb: The **box** of apples **is** heavy.

10. Punctuation

Mark	Use	Example
Full stop (.)	Ends a statement	I am a student.
Comma (,)	Separates items in a list, clauses, or direct address	I bought apples, mangoes, and grapes.
Question mark (?)	Ends a direct question	What is your name?
Exclamation mark (!)	Shows strong feeling	Stop that!
Apostrophe (')	Possession and contractions	Ravi's book; don't
Colon (:)	Introduces a list or explanation	You need three things: a pen, paper, and time.
Semicolon (;)	Joins closely related clauses	He was tired; he went to bed.
Quotation marks	Enclose direct speech	She said, "I am ready."
Hyphen (-)	Joins words	well-known author

11. Common Errors and Usage

Wrong	Correct	Reason
He don't know the answer.	He doesn't know the answer.	Singular subject needs does
I am knowing him.	I know him.	Stative verbs are not used in continuous form
She is more taller than me.	She is taller than me.	No double comparative
Each of the boys have a pen.	Each of the boys has a pen.	Each is singular
I have seen him yesterday.	I saw him yesterday.	Past time word needs simple past
He gave me many advices.	He gave me much advice.	Advice is uncountable
The furnitures are new.	The furniture is new.	Furniture is uncountable
Less students came.	Fewer students came.	Fewer for countable nouns

Wrong	Correct	Reason
I look forward to meet you.	I look forward to meeting you.	'to' here is a preposition, so use -ing
Me and him went.	He and I went.	Use subject pronouns as subjects